

Equipment You Must Not Have

The following equipment is considered unsafe and is not allowed on your vehicle:

1. A red light showing from the front except on an emergency vehicle.
2. A bell, siren, or exhaust whistle except on an emergency vehicle.
3. A muffler cutout.
4. Anything extending more than three inches beyond the left side or six inches beyond the right side of the body, running board, or fenders of your car.
5. Flashing red lights on the front except on emergency vehicles, school buses, and church buses.
6. A radar interference device designed, manufactured, used, or intended to be used to interfere with, scramble, disrupt, or cause to malfunction a radar or laser device used to measure a vehicle's speed.

Minimum Road Clearance

A vehicle must not be modified or weighted in such a manner where the body is below the lowest part of the rims of the wheels.

Optional Equipment for Vehicles

The following equipment is considered optional and is not required to be on your vehicle.

Table 12: Optional Equipment for Motor Vehicles

Optional Item	Description
Spotlight	Spotlights must be turned off for a vehicle approaching from the opposite direction. If headlights fail, it may be used with the beam striking the road not more than 50 feet in front of the vehicle on which it is used.
Side cowl or fender light	Two of these types of lights are permitted; must show amber or white light without glare.
Running board courtesy lights	One running board courtesy light is permitted on each side; must show amber or white light without a glare.
Backup lights	Two backup lights are permitted separately or in combination with other lights. Do not use when vehicle is in forward motion.
Flashing lights	Widespread flashing lights may be used on any vehicle to warn of unusual traffic hazards; must show flashing amber or white to the front and flashing amber or red to the rear and must flash simultaneously.
Additional lights	Any motor vehicle may have up to three additional driving lights mounted on the front, not less than 12 inches but not more than 42 inches from the road surface.
Sunscreen or window tinting	If sunscreen or window tinting is used, it must comply with the appropriate state regulations for your vehicle make and model.

Registration of Vehicles

All vehicles must be registered in the owner's county of residency. Once the vehicle is properly registered, a registration sticker will be issued that must be displayed on the vehicle's windshield or on the rear license plate of a motorcycle or moped.

1. An owner must register a newly purchased vehicle within 30 days of purchase.
2. Nonresident truck owners may be issued 30-day temporary registration permits for certain movements of farm products and machinery during harvesting season.
3. Under certain conditions, temporary registration permits and reduced registration rates for special vehicles may be obtained.
4. Buyers' temporary tags are recognized for 60 days; dealers' metal registration plates may be used on any dealer-owned vehicle except for commercial purposes (vehicle inspection is required).
5. A manufacturer's metal registration plate may be used for vehicle testing purposes only; a vehicle inspection is required. Dealers temporary cardboard tags may be used for demonstrating a vehicle for sale, or for transporting or servicing vehicles without a motor vehicle inspection. These vehicles may not be used for driver license driving exams.
6. Farm registered vehicles, in addition to use for farm and ranch purposes, may be used as a means of passenger transportation for members of the family to attend church or school, to visit doctors for medical treatment or supplies, or for other necessities of the home or family. Farm registered vehicles may not be used for gainful employment.
7. For registration applications and detailed information, consult your County Tax Assessor-Collector or the Texas Department of Motor Vehicles (DMV).